



IN THE FAST LANE

Coforge's Sudhir Singh has doubled down on building deep engineering expertise

BY **KARAN DHAR**

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HEN SUDHIR SINGH was roped in to turn around IT services firm Coforge (formerly NIIT Technologies) in 2018, he made a conscious call to choose relevance over scale. This meant walking away from most industries that the IT firm used to service. Singh, the CEO and executive director at Coforge, sharpened the company's focus on a select set of industries to build domain expertise.

"Even within those select industries, we started hyper-specialising. For example, it was only speciality insurance within insurance, it was initially capital markets within banking, and only airlines within travel and hospitality," Singh tells *Business Today*. Cut to 2026, the IT firm is on the cusp of quadrupling its revenue over the last eight years to almost \$2 billion in FY26, says Singh.

The turnaround of the decades-old mid-tier IT firm has been recognised in *BT-PwC India's Best CEOs* list this year. It has been a long journey for a company that missed the outsourcing bus, as erstwhile promoters were too invested in education. Gradually, there was a revamp of the top leadership team, and the company was rebranded as Coforge in 2020. The Princeton, New Jersey, and Greater Noida-headquartered company made a massive bet to acquire Silicon Valley-based AI-native firm Encora for \$2.35 billion in December last year. "We were leaning into AI (artificial intelligence), and platform-led delivery well before it became fashionable and the entire hoopla around Gen AI started," says Singh.

Singh started his career in 1995 with a stint at Hindustan Unilever Ltd (HUL) in the sales and marketing division after completing his MBA from IIM-Calcutta. He brought with him something that wasn't taught at the business school—execution intensity. "Execution possibly makes all the difference when it comes to a team or an organisation," says Singh, calling it the most important skill. "It takes years to build that culture. It must be done consistently, daily and over a period. If that muscle is built up, that becomes the biggest differentiator or moat for an organisation," he adds.

For Coforge, buying Encora has created a \$2.5 billion tech services powerhouse purpose-fit for the AI era, further accelerating its execution intensity. "In the future, AI is going to be the core driver of enterprise re-inven-

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